Harry Coppock, PhD

Research Scientist | 10 Downing Street Fellow | Honorary Lecturer

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Experience and Appointments

Research Scientist 2023 – 2026
UK AI Security Institute (AISI)

- First technical hire; helped establish AISI and build its evaluation capacity from the ground up.
- Developed and implemented evaluation methods for emerging AI capabilities; evaluated 20+ frontier models before deployment.
- Contributed to open-source evaluation tools (Inspect, HiBayES, SandboxEscapeBench) and advanced the science of AI evaluation (e.g. inference-time scaling).

10 Downing Street Fellow (Deputy Director) 2023 – 2026
10 Downing Street

- Advise on and lead AI projects addressing Prime Minister priorities, combining hands-on research and engineering with direction of technical and delivery teams.
- Taught the Prime Minister to code and delivered AI educational sessions at Heads of Departments away days; investigated failure mechanisms in LLM medication reviews.

Senior AI Adviser to the Permanent Secretary 2026
Department of Health and Social Care

- Conducted an independent review of NHS AI preparedness (2026), commissioned by the Permanent Secretary; all recommendations were signed off by leadership.
- Examining barriers to NHS adoption and use of AI in light of current and forecast capabilities.

Honorary Lecturer in Deep Learning 2023 – 2026
Imperial College London

- Teach deep learning in the Department of Computing, covering generative models, attention, evaluation, and efficient training and inference. Selected lecture notes.

Founder 2023
Maat

- Founded an AI due diligence consultancy for M&A; developed evaluation suites, hired two employees, and secured clients including Pfizer, Candesic, and venture capital firms.
- Closed with positive net cash flow to avoid a conflict of interest on entering government.

Research Scientist (40% secondment) 2021 – 2023
The Alan Turing Institute

- Conducted a nationwide evaluation finding no evidence that audio-based AI classifiers improved COVID-19 screening over symptom checkers; published in *Nature Machine Intelligence*.

Service and Interests

AISI ML reading group: organised weekly sessions (2024 – 2026).

Imperial community leadership: PhD Equality, Diversity and Culture Representative (2021 – 2023); lead organiser of the first two African Caribbean Hackathons (2022 – 2023).

Family farm: spend holidays and spare time herding and milking sheep, making cheese, preparing fields for hay, and helping with animal care, fencing, and general farm upkeep.

I enjoy time in nature, sport with friends, and travelling to places that feel different from the UK.

Selected Publications

Full publication list: Google Scholar.

Can AI agents conduct open-ended AI research? Early evidence from two case studies
arXiv preprint 2026

Open-world evaluations for measuring frontier AI capabilities
arXiv preprint 2026

Quantifying Frontier LLM Capabilities for Container Sandbox Escape
ICML — **Oral** 2026

Measuring AI Agents' Progress on Multi-Step Cyber Attack Scenarios
NeurIPS 2026

CivBench: A Long-Horizon Benchmark for Tool-Mediated Agents in Civilization VI
NeurIPS 2026

Quantifying Biases in LLM-as-a-Judge Evaluations
ICML 2025

Establishing Best Practices for Building Rigorous Agentic Benchmarks
NeurIPS 2025

HiBayES: A Hierarchical Bayesian Modeling Framework for AI Evaluation Statistics
ICML workshop: Statistical Frameworks for Uncertainty 2025

A Real-World Evaluation of LLM Medication Safety Reviews in NHS Primary Care
npj Digital Medicine — **Accepted** 2026

Audio-based AI classifiers show no evidence of improved COVID-19 screening over simple symptoms checkers
Nature Machine Intelligence 2023

COVID-19 detection from audio: seven grains of salt
The Lancet Digital Health 2021

End-to-end convolutional neural network enables COVID-19 detection from breath and cough audio: a pilot study
BMJ Innovations 2021

Education

PhD, Artificial Intelligence, *Imperial College London* 2020 – 2023
AI Evaluation; self-supervised learning for auditory inference.

PGCert, Higher Education, *Imperial College London* 2021 – 2022

MSc, Artificial Intelligence, *Imperial College London* 2019 – 2020
Distinction (82%); Distinguished Individual Project Prize.

MEng, Materials Science and Engineering, *University of Manchester* 2015 – 2019
First class (84%); highest-performing student in each of the four years.

Selected Awards

- **Winner**, ChinaTalk's $25K Evals for the Situation Room competition, for The Byerley Test. 2026
- Received an award for **technical expertise and contributions to establishing the UK AI Security Institute (AISI)**, following nomination and panel review. 2025
- **Winner**, Berkeley AgentX LLM Agent Competition. 2025
- **Runner-up**, Faculty of Engineering GTA of the Year, Imperial College London. 2023
- **Award for Well-Being**, Imperial College London. 2023
- Imperial College London's **Distinguished Individual Project Prize** for work on Vector Quantised-Variational Autoencoders (VQ-VAEs) for representation learning. 2020
- The University of Manchester's **Outstanding Academic Achievement award**, awarded to 0.5% of the graduating cohort to recognise exceptional academic achievement. 2019
- The Faculty of Engineering Prize for **highest performance in Years 1, 2, 3, and 4**. 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019
- **The Captain's Prize** for my service as Head Boy at QEH School. 2014